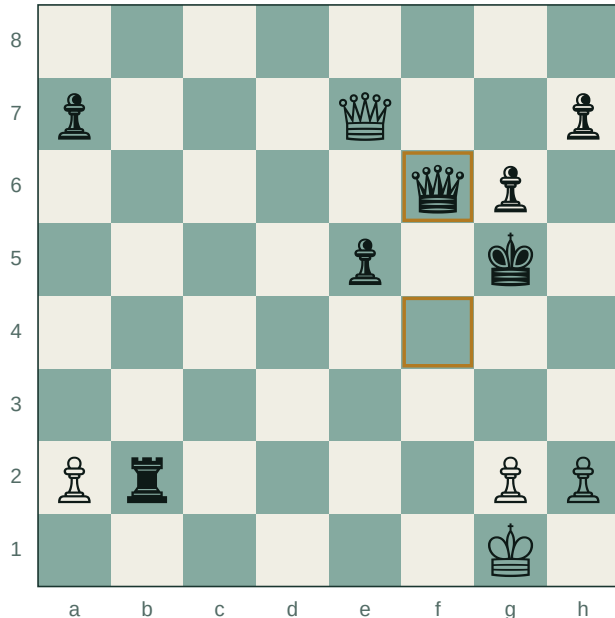


Deflection tactics: White, move 37

Deflection tactics

White to move



Previous move: 36...Qf6. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

37. h4+ Kf5 38. g4+ Kxg4 39. Qxf6

37.h4+ Check restricts Black to 6 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **37...Kf5**.

38.g4+ Check restricts Black to 3 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **38...Kxg4**.

39.Qxf6 The queen captures the queen on f6.

At the end, nominal material is White 11 / Black 9 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +8. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +8: the balance goes from -6 to +2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A replacement defender or an intermediate check can keep the target safe even after the original defender moves.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Deflection distracts a defender from a critical job. Its new square matters less than the fact that it no longer guards the original target.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the defender's job, find a forcing way to divert it, and calculate the move that exploits the abandoned square.

The defending king is on g5. Absolute pin: queen on f6.